Outlook

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Follow-up: the same arrears amount may need a different response

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Collections needs to distinguish temporary operational failures, short-term cash-flow stress and sustained affordability problems. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. Different teams have produced different answers from the same period, so population and timing rules need to be visible.

Could the answer be that bank-side processing issues are entering collections? Or are we actually seeing that some customers recover after payday? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that repeat failures and complaints indicate deeper stress.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use November 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is which treatment path, contact tone and escalation should apply. Please send a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from collections cases, promises to pay and recovery payments; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions; the latest closed loan files available by the request date, including affordability, pricing and origination risk fields. The data contains behavioural indicators, not a complete vulnerability or hardship assessment.

Regards